

Unit Introduction – Echoes of the Past

Overview

Students examine what they already know about the place known as Tkúpa (also known as Echo, Oregon), using a timeline activity. Students learn about archaeology and consider how this method of investigating the past can provide new and different information compared to other methods of interpreting history.

Estimated Delivery Time

50 minutes

Essential Question (EQ)

What is the *history* of Tkúpa (Echo, Oregon)? How are we going to learn the story?

Supporting Questions

Why is studying the past important?

What is archaeology?

How do historians and archaeologists interpret the past?

Success Criteria

I am learning...

...the history of Tkúpa (Echo, Oregon) and how historians and archaeologists interpret the past.

I will know I am successful when...

...I can name some of the important events related to this place and can talk about how historians and archaeologists learn about the past.

Ičiškiin Sínwit [Sahaptian Vocabulary]

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Lesson Vocabulary

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Background Information for Educators

Review background information prior to teaching the lesson.

(Direct links can be found in the online version of the lesson plan.)

- > Skim these two chapters excerpted from the National Council for the Social Sciences publications to understand the framing of this and all the other lessons in the unit: [*How Do We Teach Elementary Students to Think Like Historians?* by Tammara Purdin](#) and [*How Can Teachers Use Local History to Make National Trends More Tangible, Compelling, and Meaningful?* by Lightning P. Jay.](#)
- > Read [this Oregon Encyclopedia article](#) about the town of Echo.
- > Consider your own perspective about history. Have you always assumed that there is one “correct” version of the past that can be communicated to your students as the objective “truth”? It can be challenging to balance the need to communicate historical information clearly and simply with the very real complexities of humans throughout time. It may take some processing and reflection to feel comfortable with this – this unit provides an excellent opportunity to practice.

Materials Needed

Gather the following materials:

- > Poster paper or dedicated whiteboard space for a whole-class version of the [Know Wonder Learn \(KWL\)](#) graphic organizer for ongoing assessment. You could use the Promethean/smart board to save this and open it periodically HOWEVER, an option that can stay up/visible all the time for passive engagement and other connections is helpful.

- > “Tule Place Reflection Booklet” [[Website: For Educators > Printables](#)]
Print out and make one copy per student. The booklet will be used throughout the unit to record individual student versions of the KWL graphic organizer.
- > Slide deck with embedded video(s). [[Website: For Educators > Slides](#)]
There is additional information in the “notes” section of the slideshow that may help you facilitate lessons.
- > Timeline Card Activity – 1 set of cards per table group (6 sets provided)
[Digital masters are available](#) if you need to make more sets.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Part One: Introduction (10 minutes)

1. Warm Up

- Ask students if they have heard of a place nearby called “Tḱúpa” (you can practice the pronunciation using the interactive glossary!)
Explain that this is the Indigenous name for the place we now more commonly call Echo, Oregon.
- Ask students to consider what they know about this place.
Guiding questions can include:
 - *Who lives in Echo, Oregon? Who has lived there? How long?*
 - *What do people who live there do for work? For fun?*
 - *What does the community look like (geographically or demographically)?*
 - *Which cities is Echo close to? How is it different from or similar to those cities?*
 - *How do people travel to, from, past, or through Echo?*
- Give students a minute or two to discuss their ideas with a partner or their table group.

2. K-W-L Graphic Organizer

- Call on students to share and generate a list of what the class collectively knows about Echo in the “Know” column of your whole-class graphic organizer. (Be mindful of fact-checking and filtering this list as you write it to ensure accuracy and relevance.)

Possible responses: Students will likely say that they know people from Echo or have driven through or by the town on their way to somewhere else. They might know that it’s near Hermiston or Stanfield, or even Pendleton, or that it’s on the Umatilla River. They might even recall from other units/lessons that there was a Fort there or that it was on the Oregon Trail.

- As you compile a list of what the class knows, students can also record the class ideas on the “Know” page of their KWL graphic organizer on page 1 of their Reflection Booklet. (Students can also copy the list later during a writing period if writing speed is a concern.)
- Next, ask students to consider what they may *want* to learn about Tkúpa (Echo, Oregon). As you compile a list of what the class wonders on the whole class graphic organizer, students can also record these ideas on the “Wonder” page of their KWL graphic organizer on page 2 of their Reflection Booklet. (Students can also copy the list later during a writing period if writing speed is a concern.)

You may need to guide their inquiries towards questions like:

- *How long have people lived there?*
- *How long has there been a city there? Was it always called Echo?*
- *How has the community changed over the years?*
How has it stayed the same?
- *When were Native people removed from the area? Why?*
[After the Treaty of 1855, they were moved to the reservation.]

3. Talking Point

Echo is right down the road from where we are now, and some interesting and important things have happened there throughout our local history! Over the next couple of weeks, we are going to learn much more about our local history, and how it fits into Oregon's history and the United States' history that we have been learning. We will learn about the people who lived in Echo in the past and what their lives were like. We will learn about the many ways that the city of Echo has changed over the years and some ways that it hasn't.

FOR TEACHERS *IN* ECHO:

Even though our class knows a lot about our city, we still have some things we want to learn more about. Over the next couple of weeks, we are going to learn much more about the history of our community and how it fits into Oregon's history and the United States' history that we have been learning. We will learn about the people who lived here before us and what their lives were like. We will learn about the many ways our city has changed over the years and some ways that it hasn't.

Part Two: The History of Tkúpa (20 minutes)

Students will begin to learn about the many meanings of this Tule Place that we now call Echo and the many events that have occurred there. This activity provides each group of students with a set of cards; each card has an event (some with dates) from national, state, or local (Echo) history.

NOTE: Students should already be familiar with at least *some* of the events through other curricula about national and state history. The purpose of this activity is to help students contextualize specific historical events and local places in relation to other historical events or places. In this lesson, the activity serves as a pre-assessment. When the activity is repeated at the close of the unit, it will serve as a post-assessment.

4. Timeline card activity

This activity is centered around a custom deck of 25 cards. There are 24 historical events included in the deck - one side of each card only has a depiction and description of the event, the other side of the card also includes

a chronological date or date range of the event. This can be used as a way for students to self-check after making their best guess of ordering the cards or can be used for students to passively learn as they practice putting the cards in chronological order.

- Divide students into groups of 3 to 5 (or use existing table groups if you have them)
- Distribute one set of timeline cards to each group of students and provide the instructions on slide 3:
 - Each of your groups has a deck of cards that show various aspects (plot points) of history. Each card has an event or a description of a place named and depicted on it. Some of the cards will show events from the history of the United States or the state of Oregon that you are all probably familiar with. Other cards will show events or time periods connected to the place we now call Echo, Oregon.
 - Your task is to work together to put these cards in the order that you think the events happened, earliest to latest (chronological order). [some students may benefit from thinking about each card as a plot point in a story – their job is to tell a story that makes sense using the cards.]
 - If there are cards that you can't decide where they should go, set them aside in a pile to learn more about them later.
- Provide students with 10-15 minutes to arrange the cards. If students are struggling to engage with the activity because they don't know where a card goes, remind them about the "learn more later" pile.
- After groups have come to a consensus on the arrangement of their cards, you will take a photo of each table's "timeline" as a pre-assessment.

NOTE: The summative assessment at the close of the unit provides an opportunity to complete this activity again after learning about the events in more detail. You will want to be able to compare their timelines to evaluate what they've learned.

5. Activity Debrief (5 mins)

- After you've taken a picture of each group's "timeline," you might tell the class that each group has (almost certainly) arranged events in a different order than their neighboring groups.
- Call on a member of each group to share with the class one of the cards that their group either found challenging to put in order or one that they're excited to learn more about.
- Some students will likely be concerned whether they have arranged the cards in the correct order and may ask how to know if they've "gotten it right"? There are two things to consider in response to this question:
 - 1) Not all cultures think of time in a linear way but rather [a winding or circular path \(Marker 2011\)](#). There may not be one single correct order of events. Some cards might span more time than a single card can illustrate.
 - 2) You may also want to answer their question with another question, "*How **would** we know? Or how could we find out?*" These questions can also be used to transition to the upcoming discussion of archaeological methods used to learn about the past.

Part Three: Archaeology and History (5 - 7 minutes)

6. Talking Point

We're going to watch a short video that will give us some ideas about how people who study the past would figure out how these different events connect to each other as part of a larger story.

7. Echoes of the Past Video (5 minutes)

- Show the video embedded on slide 4.

Part Four: Closure/Reflection (5-10 minutes)

8. Revisit the KWL Graphic Organizer [Slide 5]

- Revisit the class KWL with the new perspective of an archaeologist and prompt students to mention any **new** things they wonder about or things they learned about Echo in the activity (write them as appropriate). **TIP:** Use a different colored marker/pen to help make students' learning visible over time!
- Have students record any new wondering or learning on the appropriate pages of their Reflection Booklet pages 2 and 3. Students can also copy the list later during a writing period if writing speed is a concern.

Assessment

This lesson can be assessed using the following:

- > A picture of timeline cards for each group to document prior knowledge
- > KWL graphic organizer in the Tule Place Reflection Booklet pages 1-3

Support for All Students

Student supports include:

- > A scaffolded version of the booklet is available for students who would benefit from more structured guidance. This version is designated by the river icon on the cover page. [[Website: For Educators > Printables](#)]
- > You can turn on closed captions for any of the videos to help students follow along. Transcripts are also available.

Extensions

Student extensions include:

- > Consider including the vocabulary from this lesson in other spelling or language practice by using the words in your regular spelling lessons or by having students make flashcards to acquire new vocabulary.
- > Consider these alternative delivery options for the Timeline Card Activity:
 - Give each table group 5 cards and then have them present the order of their cards (perhaps with a picture on the board) and explain to their classmates why they think the cards go in that order

- Could also have students draw the timeline collectively as a class once each group has solidified their piece of the timeline and figured out where/how theirs connects to other groups
- > Archaeological methods provide many opportunities to explore mathematics. If you or your students are particularly interested in exploring this, here are some examples of how you might use archaeology to frame a math lesson:
 - Lay out and label a masking tape grid on the floor and place objects throughout the grid. (Or create a slide or digital image showing the location of various artifacts on a x/y grid.) Have students use the coordinate system to plot/draw where objects are located and record the x and y coordinates of each item.
 - Provide students with the x, y, (and z) measurements for a hypothetical excavation and have them calculate the area (or volume) of the archaeological excavation. Typical excavation units are 1 meter by 1 meter and can be as deep as 1.5 meters.

Oregon Grade 4 Social Science Standards (2024)

- 4.H.CH.1** Identify and examine the Indigenous sovereign people of Oregon prior to and during waves of exploration and settlement from Europe and the United States.
- 4.G.MM.5** Explain how the contributions of the Indigenous Tribes of Oregon and various historical and contemporary immigrant groups create the diverse culture of present-day Oregon.
- 4.G.HI.6** Assess how physical geography and changing environmental factors affect land use and shape the cultural characteristics of a society.

Oregon Grade 4 English Language Arts Standards (2026)

- 4.RI.4** Identify, read, pronounce, and determine the meaning of general academic and domain-specific words or phrases in a text relevant to a grade 4 topic or subject area, and describe and explain how those words and phrases impact meaning.

- 4.RI.5** Describe the overall structure the author uses to organize the events, ideas, concept, or information.
- 4.RI.7** Interpret information presented visually, orally, or quantitatively in print and non-print formats and explain how the information contributes to an understanding of the text in which it appears.
- 4.W.2e** Use precise language and domain-specific vocabulary to inform about or explain the topic.
- 4.L.3a** Choose words and phrases to convey ideas precisely.
- 4.L.4b** Use concrete and common, grade-appropriate Greek and Latin affixes and roots as clues to the meaning of a word.
- 4.SL.1d** Review the key ideas expressed and explain their own ideas and understanding in light of the discussion.